

Direct Deposit Failures: Support Runbook

Owner: Customer Support. Use this when an employee says they were not paid by direct deposit.

First five minutes

- 1 Open the payroll in Meridian and check the employee's payment status: **Sent**, **Returned**, or **Held**.
- 2 If the status is **Sent** and the pay date is today, ask the employee to wait until 5:00 PM local time; some receiving banks post deposits late in the day.
- 3 If the status is **Returned**, read the return code on the payment detail page and follow the table below.
- 4 If the status is **Held**, the payroll was flagged by risk review. Escalate to the Risk queue; support cannot release held payments.

Return codes

- **R01, insufficient funds:** the employer's account could not cover the debit. The employer must fund the payroll by wire before Meridian re-sends. Payments are re-sent the same day if the wire arrives before 2:00 PM Eastern.
- **R02, account closed:** the employee's account is closed. The employee updates their bank details in the employee app; the employer then issues the net pay as an off-cycle payment or a manual check.
- **R03, no account / unable to locate:** usually a typo in the account details. Same fix as R02. Do not read account details back to the caller.
- **R29, corporate customer advises not authorized:** the employer's bank blocked Meridian's debit. The employer must add Meridian's ACH company ID to their bank's debit allow list. The ID is shown on the customer's Billing page.

Funds timing after a return

Returned funds come back to Meridian within 2 to 4 banking days and are credited to the employer's next payroll unless they ask for a refund. Refunds are issued by the Payments team within 5 banking days of a refund request.

When to escalate to Engineering

Escalate with a ping to **engineering** if more than 20 employees from the same company show Returned with the same code on one pay date, or if any payment shows **Sent** but has no trace number after 24 hours.